MONTHLY UPDATE

Benin: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Cybersecurity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

TECHNOLOGY
AI

CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services

Governance

Legislation and regulation

LOI 2017-20 PORTANT CODE DU NUMERIQUE

- **Société : Votre patron peut-il lire vos messages WhatsApp professionnels ?** — La Nation, 5 September 2026

  Benin's La Nation explains how the country's Digital Code limits employers' access to staff WhatsApp messages. Owning a work phone or computer does not give an employer the right to read personal conversations; monitoring of accounts used only for work must serve a work purpose and follow the code's personal data rules, including article 379.

AUTHORISATION OF ONLINE MEDIA BY THE AUDIOVISUAL REGULATOR

- **Régulation des médias en ligne: 89 organes autorisés par la Haac** — La Nation, 2 October 2026

  Benin's media regulator HAAC signed conventions with 89 online media outlets in Cotonou on 1 October 2026, completing its authorisation process for websites offering online audiovisual and written-press services. The outlets now operate under the information and communication code and the digital code.

Data protection

DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITY

- **IA et flux transfrontaliers en Afrique : L'appel de l'Apdp-Bénin à une gouvernance fiable des données** — La Nation (Bénin), 3 September 2026

  The president of Benin's personal data protection authority (APDP), Luciano Hounkponou, set out four measures for trusted cross-border data flows at a regulators' forum held with MTN Group's fintech summit in Johannesburg on 1–3 September 2026: stronger legal frameworks, secure and interoperable systems, shared governance and user education. He also called for closer cooperation between data protection and financial supervisors.

DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITY SWORN OFFICERS

- **17 APDP Benin officers sworn in to strengthen commitment to personal data protection** — TechReviewAfrica, 15 September 2026

  Seventeen officers of the data protection authority were sworn in before the Cotonou court of first instance on 14 September under the digital code, formally binding them to the obligations of their duties.

Regional collaboration

TRILATERAL BORDER-MODERNISATION STEERING COMMITTEE

- **Nigeria, Benin Republic move to close trade gaps at Seme Border** — Nigerian Tribune, 11 September 2026

  NIGERIA

  The Nigeria Customs Service offered Benin's customs a real-time exchange of declarations, manifests, transit data, risk profiles and enforcement alerts at the Sèmè–Kraké one-stop border post on 11 September 2026. Comptroller-General Adewale Adeniyi said the two services work under one roof but not on one system; Benin's customs chief endorsed the proposal. No timetable is given.

COOPERATION AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE BENINESE AND TOGOLESE DATA-PROTECTION AUTHORITIES

- **L'Instance de Protection des Données à Caractère Personnel (IPDCP) et l'Autorité de Protection des Données Personnelles du Bénin (APDP) renforcent leur coopération à Lomé - IPDCP** — IPDCP Togo, 4 October 2026

  TOGO

  Togo's data-protection authority hosted its Beninese counterpart in Lome on 2 and 3 October for a working session on sharing experience and building skills. It follows the Togolese authority's mission to Benin on 18 August and the two bodies' cooperation agreement.

Standards

NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY RÉFÉRENTIEL FOR AI SYSTEMS

- **Transformation numérique : Le Bénin veut accélérer avec l'IA et miser sur ses propres talents** — CADRECO, 9 October 2026

  Benin's public-sector digital chiefs met in Cotonou on 8 October 2026 at a conference now covering digital transformation and innovation, where an AI cybersecurity framework with four risk tiers, an AI officer and an ethics committee was presented. Officials cited shortages of staff, equipment, servers and funding in administrations, and the minister stressed developing local solutions and talent.

ICT Infrastructure

Cybersecurity

CLUB OF INFORMATION-SECURITY OFFICERS (CLUB DES RSSI)

- **Cybersécurité au Bénin: Le club des Rssi porté sur les fonts baptismaux** — La Nation Bénin, 29 September 2026

  Benin's information security officers founded a professional club at a constituent general assembly on 26 September 2026, adopting statutes and electing an 11-member board chaired by Athanase Atchome. The club plans training, workshops, experience sharing and promotion of international security standards across public and private institutions.

NATIONAL DIGITAL INVESTIGATIONS CENTRE COMPLAINT POINTS

- **Bénin : le CNIN ouvre trois points de plainte à Porto-Novo, Abomey et Parakou** — Bénin Web TV, 3 October 2026

  Benin's National Centre for Digital Investigations, CNIN, which reports to the Presidency, opened three complaint desks outside Cotonou, in police premises at Porto-Novo, Abomey and Parakou. They take complaints about personal data breaches and digital offences, alongside the Cotonou office and the existing email route.

DPI

Data Exchange

SECUROUTE ROAD-ENFORCEMENT DATA PLATFORM

- **Infractions routières : Le Trésor invite au règlement des pénalités avant le 1er octobre** — CADRECO, 11 September 2026

  Benin's Directorate-General of the Treasury and Public Accounting told road users in a communiqué dated 2 September 2026 to check for unpaid traffic penalties on the securoute.anatt.bj portal and pay them by 1 October 2026. After that date, unpaid penalties will be recovered by force during road journeys.

CUSTOMS SYSTEMS INTERCONNECTION AT SEME-KRAKE

- **Bénin-Nigeria : les douanes interconnectent leurs systèmes pour accélérer le commerce** — wearetech.africa, 15 September 2026 NIGERIA

  The two countries' customs administrations launched a pilot interconnection of their systems at the Seme-Krake border post on 11 September, to exchange data in real time and cut repeated formalities.

Digital Identity and CRVS

SUSTAINABILITY MODEL FOR THE DIGITAL IDENTITY SYSTEM

- **Le Bénin recherche un expert international pour renforcer son système d'identité numérique** — wearetech.africa, 2 September 2026

  Benin's ANIP, through the World Bank-financed WURI programme, called for expressions of interest in an international expert on digital public infrastructure strategy, to define a sustainable economic model and institutional framework for the identification agency. The 60-day mission spread over five months covers a strategic diagnosis, a comparison of international DPI and national identity models, and a roadmap for financing, operation, maintenance and modernisation. Applications closed 8 September 2026. The question being asked is how a national ID agency pays for itself once the donor project ends.

ONLINE RENEWAL OF THE BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD

- **Bénin : la carte d'identité biométrique peut désormais être renouvelée en ligne** — Bénin Web TV, 18 September 2026

Benin's identification agency opened online renewal of the biometric identity card to all holders on International Identity Day, through its e-services platform. The procedure is started online but not fully automatic.

BIOMETRIC PROOF OF LIFE FOR PENSIONERS

- **Digitalisation de la preuve de vie : Le Ministère de l'Économie et des Finances simplifie la démarche** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin, 3 October 2026

  Benin's Ministry of Economy and Finance announced on 3 October 2026 that pensioners can complete their annual proof of life from a smartphone. After identifying with their personal identification number (NPI) and pension booklet number, they verify their fingerprints in an app and receive confirmation by SMS or email. Biometric kiosks in some public places offer an alternative.

Digital Payments and Fintech

TAX E-SERVICES FOR SMALL-BUSINESS TAX CENTRES OUTSIDE COTONOU

- **Bénin : l'impôt en ligne arrive à Parakou, Comè et Lokossa** — Bénin Web TV, 18 September 2026

  Benin's tax directorate is opening its online declaration and payment platform to the small-business tax centres of Parakou from 21 September, Comè from 28 September and Lokossa from 5 October.

SEMO OFFICIAL-MISSIONS SYSTEM AND ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF MISSION EXPENSES

- **Finances publiques : Une nouvelle étape franchie dans la digitalisation du paiement des frais de mission** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin, 25 September 2026

  Benin's finance ministry made electronic payment of official mission expenses mandatory across public administrations by a circular of 25 September 2026. This is the second phase, SEMO 2, of the mission-management platform run by the national control directorate, whose first phase was used to detect overlapping missions and fictitious staff. Geolocated proof of mission is to follow.

- **SEMO+ : La preuve de mission entre dans l'ère du numérique !** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin, 3 October 2026

  Benin's government announced on 3 October 2026 that public servants on official missions now prove their presence through the SEMO+ mobile app. They log in with their personal identification number, select the mission, share their location and confirm by fingerprint; biometric kiosks in some public places offer an alternative.

Registries

E-FONCIER NATIONAL LAND CADASTRE

- **Cadastre à Parakou : 196 474 parcelles enregistrées, les Pays-Bas saluent les avancées** — Matin Libre, 4 September 2026

  Parakou became the first Benin commune with complete cadastral coverage, 196,474 parcels registered across about 56,390 hectares, with results presented to a Netherlands embassy delegation. Platform data put 38% of registered parcels in men's ownership against 7% women's and 3% collectivites, with the owners of 21% unidentifiable; more than 11,500 cadastral registration certificates had been distributed door to door.

DECRET 2025-679 ON REGISTRATION OF CHILDREN UNDER 14

- **Bénin : acte de naissance gratuit, voici la procédure pour les moins de 14 ans** — La Nouvelle Tribune, 19 September 2026

> Benin's national identification agency (ANIP), with UNICEF, is issuing birth certificates free to children under 14 until 30 September 2026, for births registered without a certificate being collected. Parents can retrieve the identification number and certificate through the ANIP BJ app or online portal, or by USSD code *151# without internet access.

> BIRTH REGISTRATION

- **Bénin : 50 109 enfants ont obtenu gratuitement leur acte de naissance en septembre** — Bénin Web TV, 4 October 2026

  Benin's identification agency said 50,109 children received a first birth certificate free of charge in September 2026. The campaign ran from 16 to 30 September for children under 14 who had never had one.

Sectoral management information systems

> DIGITAL PLATFORM FOR IDENTIFYING AND GEOLOCATING PRODUCERS AND PLOTS

- **Compte rendu du Conseil des Ministres du 02 sept. 2026 | Secrétariat général du Gouvernement du Bénin** — Secretariat general du Gouvernement du Benin, 2 September 2026

  Benin's Council of Ministers approved on 2 September 2026 the construction of 35 integrated economic, social and digital centres in 26 communes, each combining a social protection one-stop shop, a post office and a community digital point. The same session approved a digital platform to identify and geolocate farmers and plots, and appointed technical advisers on artificial intelligence in several ministries.

> DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND MONITORING PLATFORM

- **Dividende démographique : le Bénin et 7 pays ouest-africains harmonisent leurs données** — Fraternite, 8 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Benin and seven other West African states (Burkina Faso, Côte d'Ivoire, Guinea, Mali, Niger, Senegal and Togo) are testing a platform to monitor progress on the demographic dividend at a meeting in Abidjan from 7 to 9 September 2026. The tool aims to harmonise indicators against African Union commitments on health, education, jobs and governance before wider rollout.

> ONLINE LAISSER-PASSER FOR FOREIGN VEHICLES

- **Économie numérique au niveau de la douane : La dématérialisation des laisser-passer** — Bénin Espoir, 10 September 2026

  Benin's customs directorate announced on 9 September 2026 that passes for foreign vehicles are now issued entirely online through the national platforms, replacing paper forms. No platform name, cost or usage figures are given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> INTEGRATED ECONOMIC, SOCIAL AND DIGITAL CENTRES

- **Compte rendu du Conseil des Ministres du 02 sept. 2026 | Secrétariat général du Gouvernement du Bénin** — Secretariat general du Gouvernement du Benin, 2 September 2026

  Summarised under Sectoral management information systems.

> UNIVSERVICES.BJ NATIONAL UNIVERSITY SERVICES PLATFORM

- **Bénin : UnivServices.bj centralise les services destinés aux étudiants** — Chic Infos, 18 September 2026

  Benin launched UnivServices.bj, a national portal for students at four public universities, with transport as its first live service and catering, housing and health to follow.

ONLINE LOSS CERTIFICATES

- **Bénin : les certificats de perte désormais délivrés en ligne** — La Nation, 2 October 2026

  Benin's Republican Police moved loss certificates fully online from 1 October 2026, under a service note signed that day by Director General Kokou Brice Allowanou. Certificates are now issued only through the CDSP platform at certificatdeperte.bj, with electronic payment, and police stations no longer issue them on paper.

NATIONAL ADMINISTRATIVE SIMPLIFICATION PRIZE

- **Communiqué officiel | Prix national de la simplification administrative** — Gouvernement du Bénin, 12 October 2026

  Benin's government launched a presidential National Administrative Simplification Prize on 12 October 2026, inviting public servants, citizens and businesses to propose simpler procedures, including digitisation and data sharing between administrations. Submissions are open from 29 October to 12 November 2026. The prize supports Benin's target of having all procedures online by 2030.

Technology

AI

DEDICATED AI LEGISLATION

- **Billet juridique sur la conformité juridique, une condition de réussite du déploiement des systèmes d'intelligence artificielle** — Agence des systèmes d'information et du numérique (ASIN), République du Bénin, 1 September 2026

  Benin's digital agency ASIN argued in its September 2026 quarterly bulletin that AI systems need rules on governance, liability and compliance beyond the digital code and data-protection law. It proposes risk-based regulation on the EU AI Act's four tiers and a national classification of AI systems as prohibited, subject to reinforced assessment, or deployable under transparency duties. No legal vehicle, authority or timetable is named.

NATIONAL AI AND BIG-DATA STRATEGY

- **Gouvernance de l'IA : le Bénin doit transformer son avance en résultats** — La Nation, 1 September 2026

  Benin placed third in the first Africa AI Governance Index, which scores all 54 African states across eight domains. The accompanying argument is that a governance lead has yet to become anything citizens can point to.

TECHNICAL ADVISERS ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN MINISTRIES

- **Compte rendu du Conseil des Ministres du 02 sept. 2026 | Secrétariat général du Gouvernement du Bénin** — Secretariat general du Gouvernement du Benin, 2 September 2026

  Summarised under Sectoral management information systems.

AFRICAN-LANGUAGE MODEL TRACK AT THE NATIONAL AI MEETING

- **IA / NUMÉRIQUE: Les langues africaines entrent dans la course à l'IA** — La Nation, 7 September 2026

  The Beninese edition of a continental machine-learning meeting opens a track on large language models and low-resource African language corpora, at Cotonou from 10 to 12 September.

AI-ASSISTED MALARIA DIAGNOSIS IN REFERRAL HOSPITALS

- **Paludisme : le Bénin intègre l'IA dans son dispositif national de diagnostic** — wearetech.africa, 8 September 2026

  Benin's health ministry has contracted the South Korean firm Noul to put twenty AI-assisted malaria diagnostic devices into the main public referral hospitals, moving the miLab MAL system from individual facilities into the national malaria control programme, which has classified it as a point-of-service diagnostic. The device automates blood-smear preparation, digitisation and image analysis; the supporting evidence is the vendor's account of a 2025 evaluation in 211 children, and the award date is not established.

NATIONAL-LANGUAGE VOICE DATA COLLECTION

- **NUMÉRIQUE/LANGUES BÉNINOISES : 700 heures de fongbé pour l'IA : après les voix, la question des données** — La Nation, 8 September 2026

  Benin's 'J'aime Ma Langue' project, run by the state digital agency ASIN with the Institute for Inclusive Digital Africa, collected 700 hours of Fongbe speech from 2,400 contributors in more than 20 localities to train AI in Beninese languages, reported on 8 September 2026. ASIN paid contributors more than 5.8m CFA francs. The article asks how consent, reuse and access to the data will be governed.

Capacity

Training and skills

DIGITAL CLASSROOMS IN GENERAL SECONDARY SCHOOLS

- **Bénin : Enseignement secondaire : Le Gouvernement accélère la transformation numérique avec 628 équipements informatiques** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin (APO Group), 12 September 2026

  UNICEF handed Benin's Ministry of Secondary Education 628 items of computer equipment on 11 September 2026, including desktops, laptops, projectors and printers, for 43 secondary schools in nine departments and eight departmental education offices. The equipment will set up 12 new digital classrooms, adding to 55 already in place in UNICEF's areas. No value is given.

Inclusion

Access to services

EQUAL-OPPORTUNITY CARD FOR PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

- **Politique d'identification et d'inclusion: 1 422 cartes d'égalité des chances aux personnes handicapées** — La Nation (Bénin), 23 September 2026

  Benin's identification agency ANIP handed 1,422 equal-opportunity cards for persons with disabilities to the Ministry of Family and Social Action in Cotonou on 18 September 2026. The cards, provided for under a 2017 law, give access to rights in health, education, employment and transport. ANIP issued 4,718 cards in 2024 and 2025 and has about 4,000 applications for 2026.

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